We checked your phone, so you don't have to.

The Zorah Times

VOL. 1 — WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026 — TORONTO, ONTARIO — AS OF 4:50 A.M. EDT

DAILY BRIEF — ZORAH'S DAILY HOME

YOUR DAY

Picture Day 1, hot dogs for lunch, and the coldest start of the week

Cheshvan 10 · About 4°C near drop-off, sunny high near 14°C, dry · Daily brief at sdltor.github.io/household-groceries/



Zorah, Toronto is clear and cold this morning – about 5°C before dawn and feeling closer to 2°C, dipping to around 4°C near school drop-off. The sun comes up at 7:39 and carries the afternoon to a high near 14°C, with no rain anywhere in the forecast.

At RHA it is Picture Day 1, and lunch is hot dogs with veggie sticks and potato wedges – a combination that rewards a napkin tucked in early. Picture Day 2 follows Thursday, so check which morning is Jonah's class before the good shirt goes on.

Friday is a 3:15 dismissal with candles at 6:03 for Shabbat Lech-Lecha. Jonah's hockey exhibition is at 11:30 Saturday at Bill Bolton, Shabbat ends at 7:03, and his swim is at 12:55 Sunday.

TODAY

ALL DAY	**Picture Day 1** Cheshvan 10 · Picture Day 2 is Thursday.	**RHA**
LUNCH	**Hot Dogs · Veggie Sticks · Potato Wedges** Week 1 lunches.	**RHA**

THIS WEEK

THU OCT 22 – Picture Day 2 · Chicken Fingers. **RHA**

FRI OCT 23 – 3:15 Dismissal · Grilled Cheese · Candles 6:03 p.m. **RHA**

SAT OCT 24 – Jonah-Hockey · Sabres at Penguins (Exh #3) · 11:30 a.m. Bill Bolton. **PRIMARY**

SUN OCT 25 – Jonah-Swimming 12:55 · Prosserman JCC. **PRIMARY**

MON OCT 26 – Hamburger Lunch · Gr. 1 Coffee with Claire 8 p.m. **RHA**

TUE OCT 27 – Pasta Lunch · Jr. Girls Soccer · Gr. 7 Coffee with Claire 8 p.m. **RHA**

Daily brief — https://sdltor.github.io/household-groceries/

WEATHER

14° / 4° **HIGH / LOW**



Sunny, dry Wednesday. About 5°C before dawn (feels near 2°C), dipping to about 4°C around 8 a.m., then up to a high near 14°C by mid-afternoon. No rain expected. Clear and cooling this evening, near 9°C by 8 p.m. Thursday turns cloudy and milder, high near 16°C.

THU	Overcast, milder · 4%	**16 / 5**
FRI	Partly cloudy · 0%	**12 / 9**
SAT	Overcast · 0%	**13 / 9**
SUN	Overcast, mild · 1%	**17 / 10**

Forecast: Open-Meteo, read 4:50 a.m. EDT. Sky photo: SaraYeomans, CC BY 2.0, Wikimedia Commons. A1 photo: Qviri, CC BY-SA 4.0, Wikimedia Commons.

DAILY BRIEF

Zorah's daily home page, with today's brief and this paper, is at sdltor.github.io/household-groceries.

INTERESTS

SERIOUS EATS

One sheet pan, crispy gnocchi, squash and broiled halloumi: Serious Eats' easy fall supper

Zola Gregory's Oct. 13 recipe roasts shelf-stable gnocchi instead of boiling it, then finishes the pan with arugula and a cider vinaigrette.



Zola Gregory says this vegetarian dinner began as a fridge-and-pantry rescue for a visiting friend and has since become a household staple. Her key move is roasting shelf-stable gnocchi rather than boiling it, which she finds gives the dumplings a crisp outside and a pleasantly chewy middle. Butternut squash is cut into three-quarter-inch cubes and red onion into thick slices so everything is done at the same time; tossed with olive oil, salt, pepper and a pinch of chili flakes, the pan roasts at 425F for about 40 minutes.

Halloumi goes on only at the end, because, she notes, it turns dry and rubbery if cooked too long: slices are broiled for four to six minutes until puffed and golden. A handful of baby arugula and a quick vinaigrette of olive oil, apple cider vinegar and honey cut the richness of the squash. Feta works in a pinch if halloumi is hard to find. It serves four, and apart from a small bowl for the dressing, the sheet pan and spatula are the only things to wash.

From Zola Gregory, Serious Eats, Crispy Sheet-Pan Gnocchi With Bu

WHO WHAT WEAR

Seven outfit formulas for looking put-together with very little effort

Michelle Scanga, a contributing fashion editor, argues that the best outfits are not the ones with the most layers or statement pieces but the simplest combinations that just work: a few well-chosen basics, the right proportions and one polished finishing touch. After scrolling through recent street style, she says seven formulas kept standing out, all built around clothes most people already own.

Among them: an oversize blazer over a fitted tank with relaxed black trousers, a sweater and flats; a plaid button-down with a midi skirt, flats and a leather bag; a cardigan with jeans, block-heel ballet flats and an oversize bag; and an oversize knit with silk pants and heels. Her last formula pairs a lightweight long trench with a button-down, jeans and pointed-toe heels. Her point is that chic does not require complicated styling or an entirely new wardrobe — just a handful of reliable combinations to keep in rotation.



From Michelle Scanga, Who What Wear, I'm Convinced These 7 Outfit

THE TOWN

ON THE TOWN

Jan Lisiecki Plays Grieg with the Toronto Symphony Orchestra

Thu Oct 22 at 7:30 p.m.; also Sat Oct 24 at 7:30 p.m. and Sun Oct 25 at 3 p.m. at Roy Thomson Hall. Canadian pianist Jan Lisiecki returns for Grieg's Piano Concerto, with conductor Antonello Manacorda leading Saariaho's Ciel d'hiver, a shimmering portrait of the winter sky, and Brahms's Second Symphony. Thursday evening is the clear window this week.

Glow in the Wild at the Toronto Zoo

Runs to Jan. 3, mainly Thursday to Sunday evenings; entry times vary by date at Toronto Zoo. More than 2,000 handcrafted lantern displays light a 1.5-kilometre after-dark route through the Americas, Australasia and Core Woods areas, including a lantern installation made with an Indigenous artist about the endangered Blanding's turtle. The zoo calls it an experience for all ages; dress for an outdoor evening walk.

RECOMMENDED



Southern Living's no-layers fresh apple cake for a 9x13 pan

Terrence Hayes calls a fresh apple sheet cake the perfect fall baking project: no layers to stack, easy to carry and plenty of slices. Chopped Honeycrisp apples and toasted pecans or walnuts are folded into a cinnamon-spiced batter, and it bakes at 350F for 45 to 50 minutes.

PUZZLES



6 a.m.: the picture shirt goes on the hanger, comb standing by.

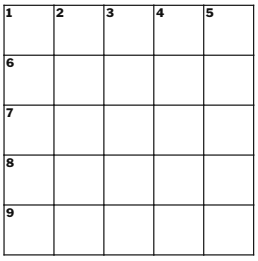


Hot-dog day. The mustard has ambitions.



Picture Day: one spotless shirt, one sacrificed napkin.

MINI CROSSWORD



ACROSS

1 Honeycrisp fruit folded into Southern Living's 9x13 sheet cake

6 Kind of spare T-shirt the Times suggests packing on Picture Day 1

7 Colour on a brush

8 Ocean ship, or the inside layer of a trench coat

9 Glow in the Wild __ times vary by date, so check before a Thursday visit

DOWN

1 __ cider vinegar, in the dressing for today's sheet-pan gnocchi, down

2 Unpatterned, unlike the plaid button-down in one Who What Wear formula

3 What a lantern-maker might add to a Blanding's turtle, or a house

4 Eye __, for a Picture Day close-up

5 Way in, like a Roy Thomson Hall door before Thursday's Grieg

ACROSS 1 APPLE · 6 PLAIN · 7 PAINT · 8 LINER · 9 ENTRY — DOWN 1 APPLE · 2 PLAIN · 3 PAINT · 4 LINER · 5 ENTRY

DEAR TIMES

Picture Day and hot dogs on the same Wednesday — what are the odds?

Dear Times, *The school calendar has Picture Day 1 today, and the lunch menu says hot dogs, veggie sticks and potato wedges. The good shirt is ironed. The mustard is, presumably, ready. Picture Day 2 is tomorrow, and nobody in this house is sure which morning is ours. Do we risk it?*

— Ketchup-Curious, Toronto

Dear Reader, Risk it, with a plan. Pack a spare plain T-shirt, tuck a napkin into the collar at noon, and go easy on the mustard. It will be about 4°C at drop-off and sunny all day with a high near 14, so the shirt can hide under a sweater on the way in. If today turns out to be the wrong day, tomorrow is chicken fingers — a much tidier lunch.

— The Times

JUMBLE

Unscramble the four words. Circled boxes spell the bonus.

RECAMA ☐☐○☐☐☐

HASQUS ○☐☐☐☐☐

NOPIA ☐○☐☐☐

LECDAN ☐☐☐☐○○

What every Picture Day photographer is hoping for — mustard-free

MILSE ○○○○○

CAMERA · SQUASH · PIANO · CANDLE — bonus SMILE

WANTED

Mustard Diplomat

Hot-dog lunch at RHA, Picture Day 1. Must keep condiments on the bun and off the good shirt.

One Comb, Pocket-Size

Picture Days today and tomorrow. Will be used once, very seriously, then lost.

FOR SALE

Trench Coat, Formula Included

Who What Wear's outfit formula: trench, button-down, jeans, pointed-toe heels. Sunny 14°C afternoon optional.

Apple Cake, 9x13, Mostly Intact

Southern Living's Honeycrisp-and-pecan sheet cake. Serves 12 to 16, or one family over a few afternoons.

NOTICES

Sheet Pan Seeks Gnocchi

Serious Eats roasts it crisp with squash and broiled halloumi. One pan to wash. Applications open tonight.

Early Candles Friday

3:15 dismissal and Shabbat Lech-Lecha candles at 6:03 p.m. Grilled cheese and challah are on Friday's school menu.